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BSHN. *Bisḥáratu'n-Núr*. Bahá'í-Verlag, 140 B.E. (1st edition) and 144 B.E. (2nd edition). Prayers and Tablets relating to life after death. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/225.pdf (1st edition). https://oceanoflights.org/table/bahaullah-prayers-and-meditations-04-fa/ (2nd edition typescript) https://oceanoflights.org/table/bahaullah-prayers-and-meditations-05-fa/ (3rd edition typescript)

BSMR. Arbab, Forough. *Bústán-i ma`árif*. Private pub., 1987. Selections from the Writings and commentary on the Faith. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/1525.pdf

BSR. *Bahá'í Studies Review*. Association for Bahá'í Studies for English-Speaking Europe, 1991- . Academic journal. Selected individual articles posted at http://bahai-library.com/series/BSR.

BSTW. Dwight Barstow collection. Collection of miscellania in English, mostly old translations and pilgrim notes. http://bahai-library.com/file.php?file=lovejoy_dwight_barstow_collection

BSW. *Bahá'í Sacred Writings*. Bahá'í Publishing, 2025. Selections from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh and the Writings and utterances of 'Abdu'l-Bahá. https://www.bahai.org/library/authoritative-texts/bahaullah/bahai-sacred-writings

BTO. Provisional translations posted inter alia at the web site http://bahaiteachings.org.

BTW. Beyond the Veil. Personal website of Brad Crawford, containing provisional translations and other materials. https://www.gobeyondtheveil.org/translations

BW. *The Bahá'í World*. Yearbook, published intermittently in 34 volumes between 1925-2006. Volumes 1-20 available at https://www.bahai.org/library/other-literature/periodicals-supplementary-materials/bahai-world/. Volumes 1-34 available at https://bahai.works/Bah%C3%A1%E2%80%99%C3%AD_World.

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BYC. Manuscript images of Writings of the Báb hosted at www.bayanic.com. Polemical source.

BYM. Khádim, Dhikru'lláh. *Bi-Yád-i-Maḥbúb.* BPT Iran, 131 B.E. Biography of Shoghi Effendi. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/676.pdf

CDB. *The Call of the Divine Beloved*. Bahá'í World Centre, 2018. https://www.bahai.org/library/authoritative-texts/bahaullah/call-divine-beloved. Available in Persian as **SMI**.

CHC. Taherzadeh, Adib. *The Child of the Covenant: A Study Guide to the Will and Testament of 'Abdu'l-Bahá*. George Ronald, 2000. http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2021/03/CHC.pdf

CHH. Lady Blomfield. *The Chosen Highway.* U.S. Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1954. https://bahai-library.com/blomfield_chosen_highway

CHU. *Compilation of the holy utterances of Bahá'u'lláh and 'Abdu'l-Bahá concerning the Most Great Peace, war and duty of the Bahá'is toward their government*. Boston: The Tudor Press, 1918. https://archive.org/stream/compilationofhol00bahrich#page/n7/mode/2up

CMB. Manuscripts at Cambridge University Library, E.G. Browne collection. See **BRHL** for details. Link to catalog entries: https://www.fihrist.org.uk/catalog/subject_sh2009116570.

COB. Taherzadeh, Adib. *The Covenant of Bahá'u'lláh*. George Ronald, 1992. http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2021/03/COB.pdf

COC. *The Compilation of Compilations* (3 vols.). Bahá'í Publishing Trust of Australia, 1991, 2000. Inventory entries refer to the continuous numbering in the original publications. Vol. 1: http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/coc1.pdf; Vol. 2: http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/coc2.pdf. Alternative versions not preserving the continuous numbering: Vol. 1: https://bahai-library.com/compilation_compilations_1, Vol. 2: https://bahai-library.com/compilation_compilations_2, Vol. 3: https://bahai-library.com/compilation_compilations_3. Some overlap in content with **BRL** and **COMP**.

COF. Shoghi Effendi. *Citadel of Faith*. U.S. Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1965. https://www.bahai.org/library/authoritative-texts/shoghi-effendi/citadel-faith/

COFP. Shoghi Effendi. *Ḥiṣn-i Ḥaṣín-i Sharí`atu'lláh*. Bahá'í-Verlag, 1997. Persian translation of **COF**. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/60.pdf

COMP. Thematic compilations of extracts from the Bahá'í Writings prepared by the Research Department at the Bahá'í World Centre, in translation and/or original texts, but not available at the official Reference Library web site (BRL). Typically only otherwise unsourced excerpts ("From a Tablet") will be cataloged. Includes COMP_DEFENCE (Defense of the Faith and the Use of Language) and its Persian/Arabic source (COMP_DEFENCEP), and the Persian/Arabic sources for the compilations on the Covenant (COMP_COVP), Family Life (COMP_FAMP), Peace (COMP_PEACEP), Prayer and Devotional Life (COMP_PDLP), Trustworthiness (COMP_TRUSTP), the Universal House of Justice (COMP_CUHJP), and Women (COMP_WOMENP). See also **BRL** for more thematic compilations.

CPF. *Chirágh-i pur Furúgh*. Private pub., 2002. Arjomand family history.

CRADLE. Handal, Boris. *The Khamsis: A Cradle of True Gold.* N.p., 2020. Biographies of the Sádát-i-Khams (the five Khamsí brothers_. https://bahai-library.com/handal_khamsis_cradle_gold

CRB. *A Crown of Beauty: the Bahá'í Faith and the Holy Land.* George Ronald, 1982. http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2021/03/CRB.pdf

CUL. Manuscripts at Columbia University Library. MS X893.7 B11 cataloged at https://clio.columbia.edu/catalog/15277075 and viewable at https://openn.library.upenn.edu/Data/0032/html/X893_7_B11.html

CUPAB. *Compilation of Utterances from the Pen of Abdul-Baha Regarding His Station*. n.p., 26 November 1906. https://bahai-library.com/abdul-baha_compilation_utterances_station

DAL. Paine, Mabel Hyde, ed. *The Divine Art of Living*. U.S. Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 2006. Compilation. https://bahaibooks.com.au/collections/ebooks-for-free/products/divine-art-living

DAS. Diary notebooks and letters of Mirza Ahmad Sohrab, Dec. 1912 – Jun. 1915. English and Persian diary notebooks and letters held in the U.S. National Bahá'í Archives. Often quoted in other sources such as **SW**. Catalog entries are indexed by date and include only the English notebooks and letters. Letters from 1 Jul 1913 through 19 Oct. 1914 found here: https://bahai-library.com/sohrab_diary_letters_1913-1914

DAUD. Dawud, Yuhanna, ed. Letters of 'Abdu'l-Bahá to Yuhanna Dawud, 1911-1919. Texts in Persian. Not same as **ROL** although there is some overlap. http://www.h-net.org/~bahai/areprint/vol3/daud1/daud1.htm

DB. Nabíl Zarandí. *The Dawn-Breakers: Nabíl's Narrative of the Early Days of the Bahá'í Revelation.* Shoghi Effendi, ed. U.S. Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1932. http://reference.bahai.org/en/t/nz/DB/

DBR. Davách, Ghulám-Ḥusayn. *Du Barádar-i Ruḥání*. BPT Iran, 1971. Account of the lives of two brothers. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/630.pdf

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DHU. Furútan, 'Alí-Akbar. *Dástánhá'í az Ḥayát-i `Unṣuríy-i Jamál-i-Aqdas-i-Abhá*. BPT Iran, 1977. Translated as **STOB**. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/470.pdf

DJT. Thompson, Juliet. *The Diary of Juliet Thompson*. Kalimat, 1983. https://bahai-library.com/thompson_diary

DJTP. *Khaṭirát-i-Juliet Thompson*. n.p., n.d. Persian translation of **DJT**. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/1704.pdf

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DLA. Goodall, Helen S. and Cooper, Ella G. *Daily Lessons received at Acca, January 1908*. Bahá'í Publishing Society, 1908 and Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1979. Pilgrim notes. Pagination refers to the 1979 edition. https://books.google.com/books?id=qk9OAQAAMAAJ

DLH. Ishráq-Khávarí, Abdu'l-Ḥamíd. *Durj-i La'álíy-i Hidáyat* (3 vols.). BPT Iran, 132 B.E. [1975]. Talks. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/729.pdf

DLLS. *Dalá'il-i Sab`ih.* Iran, 195?. The "Seven Proofs" (both Persian and Arabic versions) of the Báb. https://www.h-net.org/~bahai/areprint/bab/A-F/dalail/dalail.htm

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DRD. *Daryáy-i Dánish*. Bahá'í Publishing Trust of India, 1985. Tablets of Bahá'u'lláh in pure Persian. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/17.pdf

DRM. *Dibáchiy-i Darárí al-Malakút*. n.p., 1911. Letters of 'Abdu'l-Bahá to children.

DSDS. Fayḍí, Abu'l-Qásim. *Dástán-i Dústán*. BPT Iran, 123 B.E. [1964]. Biographies of some Persian believers. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/708.pdf

DUR. *Durr-i-Afshán* (4 vols.). BPT Iran, 1944-1951. Journal. Deepening materials for women.

DVB. *Dánish va Bínish* (5 vols.). London: Baha'I Society for Persian Arts and Letters, 1997-2004. Articles in honor of eminent scholars; vol. 1: Balyuzi; vol. 2: Ishraq-Khavari; vol. 3: Fadil Mazandarani; vol. 4: Davudi [https://adibmasumian.files.wordpress.com/2023/03/danish_va_binish_vol_4.pdf]; vol. 5: Abu'l-Fadl [http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/danish_va_binish_vol_5_reduced.pdf].

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EBTB. Balyuzi, H.M. *Eminent Bahá'í's in the Time of Bahá'u'lláh*. George Ronald, 1985. https://adibmasumian.files.wordpress.com/2023/04/ebtb.pdf

ECN. Notes of Ella Cooper, "'Abdu'l-Bahá in California". n.p, 1912. Pilgrim notes held in U.S. National Bahá'í Archives. https://bahai-library.com/cooper_abdulbaha_california_1912

EGB. Momen, Moojan, ed. *Selections from the Writings of E.G. Browne on the Bábí and Bahá'í Religions*. George Ronald, 1987. Chapter 3, "A Summary of the Persian Bayan": https://bahai-library.com/browne_momen_persian_bayan

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ESCH. Eschraghi, Armin. *Frühe Šaiḫī- und Bābī-Theologie. Die Darlegung der Beweise für Muḥammads besonderes Prophetentum (Ar-Risāla fī Iṯbāt an-Nubūwa al-Ḫāṣṣa)*. In *Islamic Philosophy, Theology and Science: Texts and Studies*, Band 57. Leiden: Brill, 2004.

ESW. *Epistle to the Son of the Wolf.* U.S. Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1988. https://www.bahai.org/library/authoritative-texts/bahaullah/epistle- son-wolf/

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FDA. Thompson, Juliet. *'Abdu'l-Bahá's First Days in America*. The Roycrofters, 192-. https://www.h-net.org/~bahai/diglib/books/P-T/T/Thompson/FDA.htm

FDDB. *al-Mujaz fí Daḥḍ al-Tuham al-Muwajjahah lil-Dín al-Bahá'í*. Ethiopia, 1974. Introductory/apologetic work, in Arabic.

FHR. Kitáb-i-Fihrist of the Báb, index of contents as listed in **SRC** pp.50-53. Items on this list are all dated 1845 or earlier.

FRGA. Finch, Ida, et. al. *Flowers Culled from the Rose Garden of Acca*. n.p., [1908]. https://bahai-library.com/finch_knobloch_flowers_acca

FRH. Rafati, Vahid. *Fárán-i-Ḥubb*. Bahá'í-Verlag, 169 B.E. [2012]. The Bahá'í Faith in Fárán (Ferdows-Khurasan). https://adibmasumian.files.wordpress.com/2021/02/frh.pdf

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GDM. *Gems of Divine Mysteries*. Bahá'í World Centre, 2002. https://www.bahai.org/library/authoritative-texts/bahaullah/gems-divine-mysteries/

GDMA. *Javáhiru'l-Asrár*. Beirut, 2003. Arabic edition of **GDM**. https://www.bahai.org/fa/library/authoritative-texts/bahaullah/gems-divine-mysteries/

GEN. Afnán, Mírzá Ḥabíbu'lláh (trans. Ahang Rabbani). *The Genesis of the Bábí-Bahá'í Faiths in Shíráz and Fárs*. Brill, 2008. Vol. 1 of "Witnesses to Bábí and Bahá'í History". https://bahai-library.com/pdf/a/afnan_rabbani_genesis_faiths.pdf

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GJV. *Gulshan-i Jávdán*. BPT Iran, 1972. Compilation on pioneering.

GOH. Saiedi, Nader. *Gate of the Heart.* Wilfrid Laurier, 2008. Exposition on the teachings of the Báb, with numerous provisional translations. http://chupin.ru/library/NaderSaiedi/Gate_of_the_Heart.pdf

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HARV. Writings of the Báb. Items 1-14: Rouhi (Sarlati) Collection, Harvard University. Small manuscript collection of single-page items. http://pds.lib.harvard.edu/pds/view/31786009?n=3&printThumbnails=no&oldpds. Tablets of Abdu'l-Baha indexed under HARV2: "National Baha'i Archive Collection", http://www.qajarwomen.org/en/collections/14133.html

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HDQI. *Ḥadíqiy-i `Irfán*. Andalib board, 1994. Tablets printed in past issues of 'Andalíb. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/667.pdf

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HKD. Furútán, 'Alí-Akbar. *Ḥikáyat-i-Dil*. George Ronald, 1981. Memoirs. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/690.pdf

HMQ. Farhangí, Masíḥ. *Ḥadáyiq-i-Míṯháq*. BPT Iran, 121 B.E. [1964]. Essay on unity, the Universal House of Justice, and other subjects. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/706.pdf

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HURQ. Lambden, Stephen. Academic website with texts, provisional translations, and notes. https://hurqalya.ucmerced.edu/scholarship/haykal-writings-b%C4%81b.

HUV. *Huva'lláh* (2 vols.). BPT Iran, 132 B.E. Prayers for children by 'Abdu'l-Bahá. Reprinted (with different ordering) by Century Press, 1991?. Catalog entries refer to Iran edition. Vol. 1 (Iran edition) https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/621.pdf. Vol. 1 (reprinted): https://reference.bahai.org/fa/t/ab/H1; Vol. 2 (reprinted): https://reference.bahai.org/fa/t/ab/H2.

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IDAB. Dávúdí, 'Alí-Murád. *Insán dar Á'ín-i Bahá'í* (vol. 1 of 3: Falsafih va 'Irfán). Kalimat, 1987. Collected works/talks. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/654.pdf

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INBA. Iranian National Bahá'í Archives volumes. Two-digit entries are from the 105-volume private printing, Iran, 1975. Digitally reprinted by the Afnan Library: http://www.afnanlibrary.org/docs/persian-arabic-mss/inba/, with typed volumes available at https://oceanoflights.org/chapter/manuscripts-fa/. Four- digit entries suffixed by "C" are taken from **SRC** Appendix 1; 6007C can be found at http://bluefin.live/wp-content/uploads/2023/05/INBA.6007C.pdf.

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IQT. *Iqtidárát va Chand Lawḥ-i Dígar*. BPT Iran, 1970. Collection of Tablets of Bahá'u'lláh. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/24.pdf

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ISH. *Iṣhráqát va Chand Lawḥ Dígar*. BPT Iran, 196-?. Collection of Tablets of Bahá'u'lláh. https://bahai-library.com/bahailib/27.pdf

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JHT. Personal web site with provisional translations by Joshua Hall. March 2017- . http://joshuahalltranslations.com/. **JHT_S**, "Supplications by Bahá'u'lláh", contains 200 translations.

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BRHL (103)	LHKM (512)	♦ TAB (776)
♦ SWB (76)	MAS (490)	YARP (750)
SWBP (70)	AYI (382)	MSHR (667)

♦ = primarily English

APPENDIX

A SUBJECT CLASSIFICATION SCHEME FOR THE BAHÁ'Í WRITINGS: MAIN HEADINGS

Questions of being

I. Degrees and Conditions of Existence

A. God and the Realm of the Divine Will
B. The Manifestations of God
C. Metaphysics and natural philosophy
D. Soul, mind, spirit

METAPHYSICS, THEOLOGY, NATURAL PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY

Questions of knowledge

II. Knowledge, Language and Symbol

A. Knowledge and the investigation of reality
B. The Word of God
C. Language, symbol and interpretation
D. Sacred Writings: modes and themes; disposition of

EPISTEMOLOGY, PHILOSOPHY OF LANGUAGE, HERMENEUTICS

Questions of conduct

III. Individual Reality and Development

A. Spiritual life and practice in relation to self
B. Spiritual life and practice in relation to God
C. Spiritual life and practice in relation to others

PERSONAL ETHICS, MYSTICISM

Questions of governance

IV. Collective Reality and Development

A. Religion and the Covenant
B. Laws and ordinances
C. Prohibitions and admonitions
D. Social teachings
E. The Administrative Order and the Bahá'í community

JURISPRUDENCE, SOCIOLOGY, ECONOMICS, POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY

Questions of historical contingency

V. Past, Present, and Future

A. Beliefs and Dispensations of the past
B. The Central Figures and events of their ministries
C. Present and future order; crisis and victory

HISTORY, ESCHATOLOGY

SUBJECT CATEGORIES: MAIN HEADINGS AND SUB-HEADINGS

If quotations from one author dominate a category (>70%), this is indicated by ● for the Bab, ● for Baha'u'llah, and ● for Abdu'l-Baha.

I.A. GOD AND THE REALM OF THE DIVINE WILL

transcendence; unknowability of God
absolute freedom; independence of God
God's love for His own Essence
self-description of God; God's self-remembrance
God as immanent vs. transcendent reality
● God as personal vs. impersonal reality
● impossibility of true worship of God
forgiveness; grace; bounty; mercy; compassion of God
justice and wrath of God
● power and sovereignty of God; omnipotence of God
● God's knowledge
names and attributes of God
essential vs. actional attributes of God
divine attributes are within all things; every atom
● God's attributes require the existence of objects
● knowledge of attributes same as knowledge of God
God's oneness [ahadiyyih and wahidiyyih]
divine unity [tawhid] and degrees of unity
● proofs for the existence of God
eternal archetypes [a'yan-i-thabitah]
the divine emanation; the all-pervading bounty of God
holy and most holy outpouring [fayd-i-aqdas and fayd-i-muqaddas]
divine emanation is ceaseless/eternal
● emanation vs. manifestation
the Primal Will
Primal Will and the Word; Remembrance; Manifestation of God
the self-generation of the Primal Will
● the Holy Spirit

I.B. THE MANIFESTATION OF GOD

station of the Manifestation of God
Greatest Name
identity/relationship of Manifestation of God to God
inability of the Manifestation/Prophet to comprehend God
● preexistence of the Manifestation of God
oneness or innumerability of the Manifestations of God
● differences between the Manifestations; station of distinction
twofold/threefold station of the Manifestation of God
Perfect Man [insan-i-kamil]
● power of the Manifestation of God
infallibility/sinlessness ['ismat]
obedience to/authority of the Manifestations of God
Manifestation of God as mediator
Manifestation of God as cause of creation
Manifestation of God as recipient of divine revelation; Holy Spirit
Manifestation of God the only route to knowledge of God
● presence [liqa'] of Manifestation of God is presence of God
● Manifestation of God speaking in the voice of Divinity
Manifestation of God as tree of life/sadratu'l-muntaha
Manifestation of God as sun
● Manifestation of God as mirror
● Manifestation of God as pen
Manifestation of God as gardener/cultivator
● Manifestation of God as divine physician
● Manifestation of God as educator
return of the Manifestations of God
categories of Prophets (major/minor/village)
innateness/early self-awareness of the Manifestations of God
essential distinction of Manifestation of God from others
● special knowledge of the Manifestation of God
lack of formal education of the Manifestation of God
● Manifestation of God does not act of own volition
● physical limitations of the Manifestation of God
● self-concealment of the Manifestation of God
sacrifice of the Manifestation of God redeems the world
proofs of the Manifestations of God

I.C. METAPHYSICS AND NATURAL PHILOSOPHY

● divine philosophy and natural philosophy
● realms of being; three realms
● material and spiritual existence; two books
● arcs of ascent and descent
four/five pathways of love
creation of the world
eternality vs. origination; creation from nothingness
seven stages of creation
alteration of the divine will [bada]
purpose/goal of creation
continual renewal of creation
● existence and nonexistence; preexistence
unity of existence [wahdatu'l-wujud]
● necessary and possible being
● infinity and eternity
● nature and God's will
perfection/imperfection of nature
law of cause and effect
● law of transformation and change
● four causes
● matter; essence; substance and form
● elementary matter cannot be annihilated
● uncompounded reality [basitu'l-haqiqah]
four elements
● all things are in motion; kinds of motion
heat and motion
one universal law; attractive power of love
● the animal kingdom
● celestial spheres [aflak]; planets; astronomy
ether/the phenomenon of light
● composition and decomposition
diversity an attribute/requirement of existence
pairs in creation; male and female; B and E; agent and patient
● things are known by their opposites

- cycles in the physical and spiritual worlds
- degrees of spirit and the kingdoms of existence
- passage of elementary matter through degrees of existence
- progress only takes place within its own degree
- higher encompasses the lower
- the lower is unable to comprehend the higher
- need for cooperation; solitary existence not possible
- competition vs. cooperation; the struggle for existence
- evolution; human evolution
  man is the sum/pinnacle/fruit of creation
- man's distinction from the animal
- the human body
- teleology; goal-directed motion
- plenitude; the pervasiveness of life in the cosmos
- need for an educator
  principle of balance/moderation/equilibrium
- interconnectedness; all things involved in all things; chain of being
- microcosm and macrocosm ['alam-i-akbar and 'alam-i-asghar]
- connection between material and spiritual worlds
- material world a reflection of the spiritual
  essential/necessary relationships

I.D. SOUL, MIND, SPIRIT

universal human capacity for spiritual recognition
- differences in human capacity
- the human soul
- human reality created in the image of God
- soul is the essential reality of man
  immateriality/ineffability of soul/spirit
- origin of the soul; the soul as emanation
  human soul as mirror; divine light, attributes within
- the human soul at midpoint of creation; the isthmus [barzakh]
  realm of similitudes ['alam-i-mithal]
- relationship of the soul to the body
  two aspects of the human soul; the higher and lower natures
  two kinds of knowledge [ilm and irfan]; sight and insight
- intelligible vs. perceptible realities
  existence; immortality of the human soul
  proofs for the existence/immortality of the soul
  soul/spirit after death
  free will and predestination; fate
- theodicy; the mystery of evil; of suffering
  mind as principle emanation/activity of the human spirit
- mind as intermediary between soul and body
- the mind's power of discovery
- power of the mind over nature
  call to acquire knowledge/sciences
- limits of the intellect

II.A. KNOWLEDGE AND THE INVESTIGATION OF REALITY

independent investigation of truth/reality
- harmony of science and religion
- four methods of acquiring knowledge
- interconnectedness of the teachings
- relativity of religious truth
  relativity and complementary truths
- nonexistence of evil; relativity of good and evil

II.B. THE WORD OF GOD

- the Word of God; influence and centrality of
  procession/appearance of the Word from God
  Word of God sanctified from time and place
- Word of God the cause of creation
- Word of God and human limitations
  superiority/incomparability of the Word of God
- Word of God is its own standard
  challenging nature/abstruseness of the Word of God
- corruption; misinterpretation of the Word of God

II.C. LANGUAGE, SYMBOL AND INTERPRETATION

- language and the structure of reality
  limits of language
  grammar and orthography
  meanings of letters and numbers; jafr (gematria)
  outward and inward meanings
  multiple meanings/interpretations in scripture
- meaning; importance of dreams and visions
- accounts of dreams and visions
- interpretation of dreams and visions
- literal interpretation
  interpretation of words and passages in scripture
- importance of authoritative interpretation
  encouragement of individual understanding/interpretation
- miracles and their interpretation
  symbolism
  symbolism of color and light
- metallurgical metaphors
  spiritual warfare/struggle
- spiritual emotions and susceptibilities
  alchemy; the elixir
- Crimson Ark; the Ark of God
  angels
- the concourse on high
  apocalyptic imagery
- mystery of the great reversal
  four pillars
  the cloud ['ama]
- ringstone symbol
  Satan/the Evil One
  fire and light; fire and water
- light and darkness
  life and death
  nearness and remoteness
- belief and denial
- the ephemeral and the eternal
  the first and the last; the seen and the hidden

II.D. SACRED WRITINGS: GENERAL THEMES; DISPOSITION OF

modes/manner/speed/size of divine revelation
praise and encouragement
exhortations and counsels
consolation and comfort
call to action
eulogies/reminiscences

martyrs and martyrdom
expressions of grief/lamentation/sadness
- suffering and imprisonment

rejection, opposition and persecution
- chastisement and requital
- poems and quotation from poetry

stories/anecdotes
humor/jokes
predictions and prophecies
prophecy and fulfillment
da'iras and haykals
personal instructions
business/financial/property matters
acknowledgment of gift; of monetary contribution
naming of children; of individuals
permission for visit/pilgrimage
- proclamation to the people of the world
- proclamation of the Cause (general or uncategorized)

proclamation to kings/rulers/prominent individuals
- proclamation to divines; to religious leaders
- proclamation to Jews
- proclamation to Christians
- proclamation to Muslims
- proclamation to people of the Bayan

petitions to authorities
authentication/disposition of the Sacred Writings
collection/ordering of the Sacred Writings
preservation/transcription of the Sacred Writings
grammatical and other discrepancies in the Sacred Writings
translation/publication of the Sacred Writings

III.A. Spiritual Life and Practice: In Relation to Self

walking the spiritual path; spiritual wayfaring; the virtuous life
- characteristics and conduct of true believers
- condition of search

knowledge of self
effort/striving
purity of heart/sincerity of intention/sanctity
detachment/severance/renunciation/patience
transience/worthlessness of the physical world
worldliness vs. other-worldliness
- transcending the material condition

composure/tranquillity/serenity
cleanliness and refinement
chastity and purity
- moderation; frugality; simplicity

wisdom [hikmat]
- sacrifice of self; mystery of sacrifice
- courage

meditation
contemplation
study/deepening
importance of reading the Sacred Writings
- rational arguments

bringing oneself to account each day
order/organization/tact/deliberation [tadbir]
- self-improvement; self-perfection; discipline

beauty/grace/aesthetics
mindfulness; concentration; focus
power of imagination/thought/right intention
acquiescence and resignation; contentment
humility/meekness/lowliness
- happiness; joyfulness; joy and sorrow

development of capacity and readiness
disregarding individual capacity/weakness
- disregarding bodily comfort
- fulfillment of true potential

bringing forth results/fruit
- spirit of faith [ruh-i-'iman]
- power of faith; power of the spirit
- power of love
- second birth
- spiritual baptism

spiritual transformation
- attainment to faith in the twinkling of an eye
- transmutation of the soul by the divine elixir
- attaining the life of the spirit
- the soul as soil; cultivation of the soul

wine as symbol of spiritual transformation
high station of the true believer
degrees of faith/certitude
- the Kingdom of God [Malakut]
- spiritual foundations of true knowledge

intuition/inspiration
mysteries and their discovery; the mystical vision
mystical themes
inmost heart [fu'ad]
evanescence and eternality; fana and baqa
living waters; water of life
recompense/reward for belief/right action
heaven and paradise; heaven and hell

III.B. Spiritual Life and Practice: In Relation to God

love of God
love as fire
pain of love
knowledge/recognition of God
- twin duties of recognition and obedience

rendering assistance to God/victory [nusrat]
- piety; righteousness; fear of God [taqwa]

thankfulness/gratitude
steadfastness/perseverance/faithfulness
- trust and reliance in God; turning to Him at all times

tests and trials; sacrifice and suffering
servitude/submission to God; repentance
- importance of prayer

power of prayer
- the state of prayer; dynamics of prayer

prayer for the Babis/people of the Bayan

- prayer for assistance/intercession
- prayer for children and youth
- prayer for tests and difficulties
- prayer for the departed
- prayer for detachment
- prayer for evening/night
- prayer for fasting
- prayer for firmness in the Covenant
- prayer for forgiveness
- prayer for justice and fairmindedness
- prayer for gatherings/meetings/assemblies
- prayer for governments and rulers
- prayer for healing
- prayer for married couples
- prayer for martyrs
- prayer for morning
- prayer for nearness to God
- prayer for opponents/enemies of the Faith
- prayer for parents
- prayer for peace and unity
- prayer for pilgrims
- prayer for pioneers and travel teachers
- prayer for praise and gratitude
- prayer for protection
- prayer for prosperity
- prayer for purity/chastity
- prayer for service
- prayer for spiritual recognition
- prayer for strength
- prayer for sacrifice
- prayer for specific individuals/groups
- prayer for the spiritual progress of others
- prayer for steadfastness/obedience
- prayer to be recited at table
- prayer for teaching
- prayer for unity
- prayer for victory and requital; triumph of the Cause
- prayer for women
- prayers (general or uncategorized)
- visitation Tablets
- presence of/reunion with God
- nearness to God
- attaining good pleasure of God
- divine grace, bounty, confirmations; spiritual capacity
- many are called but few are chosen

III.C. Spiritual life and practice: in relation to others

- the golden rule; regard for one's neighbor; doing unto others
- consorting with all; being kind/loving to all
- love and unity
- radiant countenance; bearing the divine fragrance
- being a source of light/guidance
- service to others; to the Cause of God
- serving humanity; working for progress; betterment of the world
- loving one's enemies; returning hatred with love
- forgiveness; a sin-covering eye; patience and forbearance
- spiritual communication; connections of the heart
- the power of example
- courtesy/culture [adab]
- hospitality
- compassion/kindness
- generosity [kirama]
- honesty/truthfulness/trustworthiness
- fairmindedness/personal justice [insaf]
- goodly deeds/actions
- words vs deeds
- the power of words; of speech
- silence; fewness of words
- useful occupation; acquisition of a craft/trade/profession
- work as worship
- excellence; distinction
- assistance to the poor and lowly/the orphan/the sick
- kindness to and rights of animals
- teaching the Cause; call to teach
- spiritual prerequisites of teaching the Cause
- methods of teaching the Cause
- high station of teachers of the Cause
- exalting the Word of God in teaching the Cause
- priority over other activities in teaching the Cause
- fewness of numbers not regarded in teaching the Cause
- power/influence of a single soul in teaching the Cause
- teaching one's self first in teaching the Cause
- the state of enkindlement in teaching
- being a channel for the Holy Spirit in teaching the Cause
- being a source of living waters in teaching the Cause
- pure intentions in teaching the Cause
- genuine love and affection in teaching the Cause
- zeal and fervor in teaching the Cause
- devotion/sacrifice/consecration in teaching the Cause
- kindliness/humility/self-effacement in teaching the Cause
- confidence/courage/faith in teaching the Cause
- detachment in teaching the Cause
- disregarding own capacity in teaching the Cause
- loving community spirit in teaching the Cause
- regarding the receptivity of the hearer in teaching the Cause
- scarcity of receptive souls
- pioneering/travel teaching
- confirmations and rewards in teaching the Cause

IV.A. Religion and the Covenant

- religion as reality; definitions of religion
- oneness/unity of religion
- progressive revelation; renewal of religion
- the truth of past religions and sacred scriptures
- definitions of a Baha'i; qualities of a Baha'i
- universality of the Cause
- purpose of religion in the world (personal and social)
- mission of the Manifestation of God in the world
- changing and unchanging parts of religion
- love as fundamental; spiritual foundations of religion
- religion as source of love and unity
- religion as basis of morality; of divine civilization
- religion as source/stimulus of knowledge and science
- power; greatness; centrality of the Covenant
- firmness in the Covenant
- role of the Covenant in preserving unity
- primordial Covenant; the day of alast
- Covenant-breaking and Covenant-breakers

- avoidance of Covenant-Breakers

IV.B. Laws and Ordinances

laws of God; of the Kitab-i-Aqdas
law of obligatory prayer
law of repetition/recitation of the Greatest Name
law of fasting
- laws of marriage and dowry
- law of divorce

law of inheritance
- law of burial and cremation

law of pilgrimage
law of Huququ'llah

IV.C. Prohibitions and Admonitions

- alcohol and drugs; tobacco; opium

begging; mendicancy; idleness and sloth
- bribery and corruption
- birth control; preventing procreation

confession of sins
contention and conflict
dissimulation [taqiyyih]; concealment or denial of Faith
- destruction of books
- superstition
- demons and evil spirits
- astrology and numerology

occult sciences/psychic phenomena
- reincarnation

pantheism
- idolatry

anthropomorphism
empty learning; false spirituality
- original sin
- false claims to divine revelation or spiritual stations
- fanaticism and hatred

fellowship with the wayward and ungodly
greed/envy/covetousness/attachment to the world
- gambling and games of chance

holy war [jihad]; violence in the name of God
hypocrisy
idle talk/backbiting/speaking ill of others
blind imitation [taqlid]
idle fancies; lust and passion
- lying and deceit
- monasticism; asceticism
- murder; causing physical harm
- prejudice; racial prejudice; class distinction
- priestcraft
- pride; vanity; laying claim to inner knowledge
- testing God

saddening another soul
- secret societies
- rebellion and sedition; disobedience
- religious rituals minimized or eliminated

selfishness/self-love/egotism/self-indulgence
slavery
suicide
smoking
- theft; seizing the properties of others

unchastity and adultery

IV.D. Social Teachings

lists/enumerations of Baha'i principles
- unity; oneness of humanity

love, unity, and fellowship among the friends; in the Cause
call to unity; prohibition of disunity
- unity in diversity
- unity of thought and belief
- diversity of thought and belief
- equality of men and women
- role and station of women
- universal language
- race unity; racial issues
- marriage as means of spiritual progress
- parents and children; youth; families
- rights of the eldest son; primogeniture
- education of children; moral education
- universal education
- education and the development of capacity
- high station of learning
- high station of the arts and sciences
- educational curricula
- charitable associations; humanitarian activities
- conduct in finance and business

status of material wealth; wealth and poverty
- wealth inequality and its moderation
- music and singing

literature/drama/humanities/the arts
- creativity in art
- photographs and recordings
- maintainance of degrees in society
- non-participation in politics

true liberty/freedom
justice ['adl]; social justice and divine justice
- justice and mercy
- health and healing; material and spiritual healing
- consumption of meat; vegetarianism; diet
- newspapers and the media; publications
- agriculture

IV.E. The Administrative Order and the Baha'i Community

Twin pillars; interpretation and legislation
- House of Justice
- Shoghi Effendi and the Guardianship

Hands of the Cause
- spiritual assemblies; administrative matters
- elections

consultation
- review of publications
- criticism and its limits
- spirit and form in the administration
- freedom of thought and action

spiritual meetings/gatherings; devotional gatherings; feasts
- importance of community building
- Nineteen-Day Feast
- House of Worship [Mashriqu'l-Adhkar]

- Holy Days and the Baha'i calendar
- Shrines and Holy places
- day of rest

V.A. Beliefs and dispensations of the past

- historical episodes and the lessons of the past
- Greek philosophers; Greek civilization
  Hermes/Balinus
- Zoroastrianism; Mahabad and Zoroaster
- Buddhism and Hinduism; religions of the East
- Judaism; the Torah; the Jewish people
- Adam; Adam and Eve
  Abraham/Isaac/Ishmael
  Noah
  Moses
  Mosaic imagery
- John the Baptist
- Christ; Christianity
- Christian doctrine and practice
- quotation from or interpretation of the Bible
  birth of Christ; purity/virginity of Mary
- suffering/rejection of Christ
  crucifixion/ascension of Christ
- resurrection of Christ
- Judas
- Mary Magdalene
- Saint Peter and Saint Paul
- the cross and the trinity
- return of Christ; second coming of Christ
  apostles/early disciples of Christ
- early Christian persecutions; the Pharisees
- the Christian clergy
  Christian rejection of Baha'u'llah and the Baha'i Faith
  Muhammad; Islam
  rejection of Muhammad
  family of Muhammad; early figures in Islam
- episodes from the early history of Islam
  Qur'an and Hadith quotation and interpretation
  day of Resurrection/Judgement
- Islamic laws and jurisprudence
  Islamic rituals/holy days/practices/etc.
- the Imamate; the Caliphate
- Imam 'Ali
  Imam Husayn
  the Twelfth Imam; the Qa'im
- Night of Power (Laylat al-Qadr)
  pilgrimage [Hajj] in Islam
  imagery in the Qur'an
- veiling [hijab]
  Jabulqa and Jabarsa
  Seal of the Prophets
- corruption and decline of Islam; of the Shi'ih
  Shaykhis
- Theosophy

V.B. The Central Figures; events of their ministries

twin Manifestations
the Bab/the Primal Point; station and claims of the Bab
events in the life and ministry of the Bab
Declaration/advent of the Bab
the Bayan, its laws and their abrogation
- conference of Badasht
- martyrdom of the Bab
  sacred remains/burial of the Bab
  Letters of the Living
- Tahirih [Qurratu'l-'Ayn]
  Quddus
  He Whom God Shall Make Manifest; the Bab and Baha'u'llah
- Baha'u'llah
  early years; early ministry of Baha'u'llah
  incarceration of Baha'u'llah in Siyah Chal
- banishments of Baha'u'llah
  banishment to; life in Baghdad
- Baha'u'llah in Sulaymaniyyih
- Declaration of Baha'u'llah
  banishment to; life in Constantinople
  banishment to; life in Adrianople
  rebellion and misdeeds of Mirza Yahya; the Azalis
- rejection by the people of the Bayan
  banishment to; life in 'Akka
- Mount Carmel
- Ascension of Baha'u'llah
  station/mission/authority of Abdu'l-Baha
  autobiographical account/narrative of Abdu'l-Baha
- youth and pre-ministry of Abdu'l-Baha
- Ottoman commissions of investigation
- constitutional revolution in Iran
- travels to Egypt by Abdu'l-Baha
- travels to the West by Abdu'l-Baha

V.C. Present and future world order; crisis and victory

- two kinds of civilization; material and spiritual civilization
- progress and the continual ascent of material civilization
- materialism; material vs. spiritual civilization
- East and West; communication between East and West
  praise of Western values/culture
  critique of Western values/culture
  praise of Eastern values/culture
  critique of Eastern values/culture
- forces of light and darkness; integration and disintegration
- war and peace
- present and future calamities; war; universal convulsion
- corruption and renewal; abandoning religious dogmas
- heedlessness and ignorance of the people
  greatness and influence of the Cause; of this Day
- spiritual springtime
- teachings as spirit of the age
- defending the Faith; protecting the Cause; apologetics
- growth of the Cause
- growth and progress is gradual and according to capacity
- entry by troops
  principles of the Faith adopted democratically; not imposed
- universal peace; world unity
- the Lesser Peace and the Most Great Peace
  acting according to the exigencies of the day; pragmatism
- unity of governments; political unity
- means of establishment of future civilization

- present and future expansion of arts and sciences; of technology
- spiritualization of humanity in the future; a new race of men
  coming-of-age/maturity of mankind
  critiques of capitalism, communism, socialism
- labor and management; labor relations; profit sharing
- the economic problem and its solution; voluntary giving
- promotion of commerce and industry
- relationship between government and people
- obedience to and respect for government authority
- reward and punishment
- nationalism; love of country
- status of kings; future of monarchy
- parliaments; constitutional government
- executive government; power of execution
  church and state in the future
- civil courts
- supreme tribunal
  past, present and future of Iran
- future of Haifa; of the Holy Land
- the Adamic cycle and the Baha'i cycle
  duration of the Baha'i cycle; future divine revelations

Version: 19-May-2025

TOP CATEGORIES, BY QUOTATION COUNT

As identified by a Claude 3.5 Sonnet analysis of over 27,000 machine translated writings and utterances of Baha'u'llah, the Bab and 'Abdu'l-Baha

Subject category	#
praise and encouragement	6412
steadfastness; perseverance; faithfulness	4459
power and sovereignty of God; omnipotence of God	4038
teaching the Cause; call to teach	3727
spiritual transformation	3623
the Word of God; influence and centrality of	3173
suffering and imprisonment	3039
rejection, opposition and persecution	3003
divine grace, bounty, confirmations; spiritual capacity	2945
detachment; severance; renunciation; patience	2913
transcendence; unknowability of God	2186
call to action	2153
consolation and comfort	2027
tests and trials; sacrifice and suffering	1923
spiritual emotions and susceptibilities	1833
service to others; to the Cause of God	1731
expressions of grief; lamentation; sadness	1652
forgiveness; grace; bounty; mercy; compassion of God	1626
love of God	1428
acknowledgment of gift; of monetary contribution	1395
unity; oneness of humanity	1343
martyrs and martyrdom	1321
chastisement and requital	1315
transience; worthlessness of the physical world	1297
firmness in the Covenant	1289
walking the spiritual path; spiritual wayfaring; the virtuous life	1192
prayer for spiritual recognition	1152
Covenant-breaking and Covenant-breakers	1075
spiritual prerequisites of teaching the Cause	981
greatness and influence of the Cause; of this Day	960
knowledge; recognition of God	921
thankfulness; gratitude	907
spiritual meetings; gatherings; devotional gatherings; feasts	843
servitude; submission to God; repentance	831
wisdom [hikmat]	795
growth of the Cause	767
personal instructions	754
power; greatness; centrality of the Covenant	693
love, unity, and fellowship among the friends; in the Cause	684
prayer for specific individuals; groups	667
trust and reliance in God; turning to Him at all times	655
eulogies; reminiscences	652
prophecy and fulfillment	638
heedlessness and ignorance of the people	625
station of the Manifestation of God	623
prayer for protection	536
exhortations and counsels	524
predictions and prophecies	522
humility; meekness; lowliness	519
power of prayer	518
stories; anecdotes	502
business; financial; property matters	498
prayer for steadfastness; obedience	492
education of children; moral education	475
Manifestation of God speaking in the voice of Divinity	458
permission for visit; pilgrimage	448
soul; spirit after death	438
prayer for nearness to God	427
sacrifice of self; mystery of sacrifice	427
prayer for forgiveness	411
characteristics and conduct of true believers	408
power of the Manifestation of God	407
justice and wrath of God	378
the power of words; of speech	376
House of Worship [Mashriqu'l-Adhkar]	376
prayer for the spiritual progress of others	365
spiritual communication; connections of the heart	356
the divine emanation; the all-pervading bounty of God	353
symbolism	352
rejection by the people of the Bayan	351
worldliness vs. other-worldliness	338
love and unity	337
prayer for the departed	336
Holy Spirit	332
Manifestation of God as sun	317
mysteries and their discovery; the mystical vision	315
serving humanity; working for progress; betterment of the world	310
prayers (general or uncategorized)	303
universal peace; world unity	295
forces of light and darkness; integration and disintegration	289
proofs of the Manifestations of God	278
oneness; unity of religion	278
interpretation of words and passages in scripture	276
unity in diversity	268
high station of the true believer	263
presence of; reunion with God	262
Shrines and Holy places	257
divine unity [tawhid] and degrees of unity	256
being a source of light; guidance	255
station; mission; authority of Abdu'l-Baha	247
review of publications	245
wine as symbol of spiritual transformation	240
progressive revelation; renewal of religion	239
honesty; truthfulness; trustworthiness	233
travels to the West by Abdu'l-Baha	231
living waters; water of life	228
purity of heart; sincerity of intention; sanctity	227
material and spiritual existence; two books	222
suffering; rejection of Christ	220